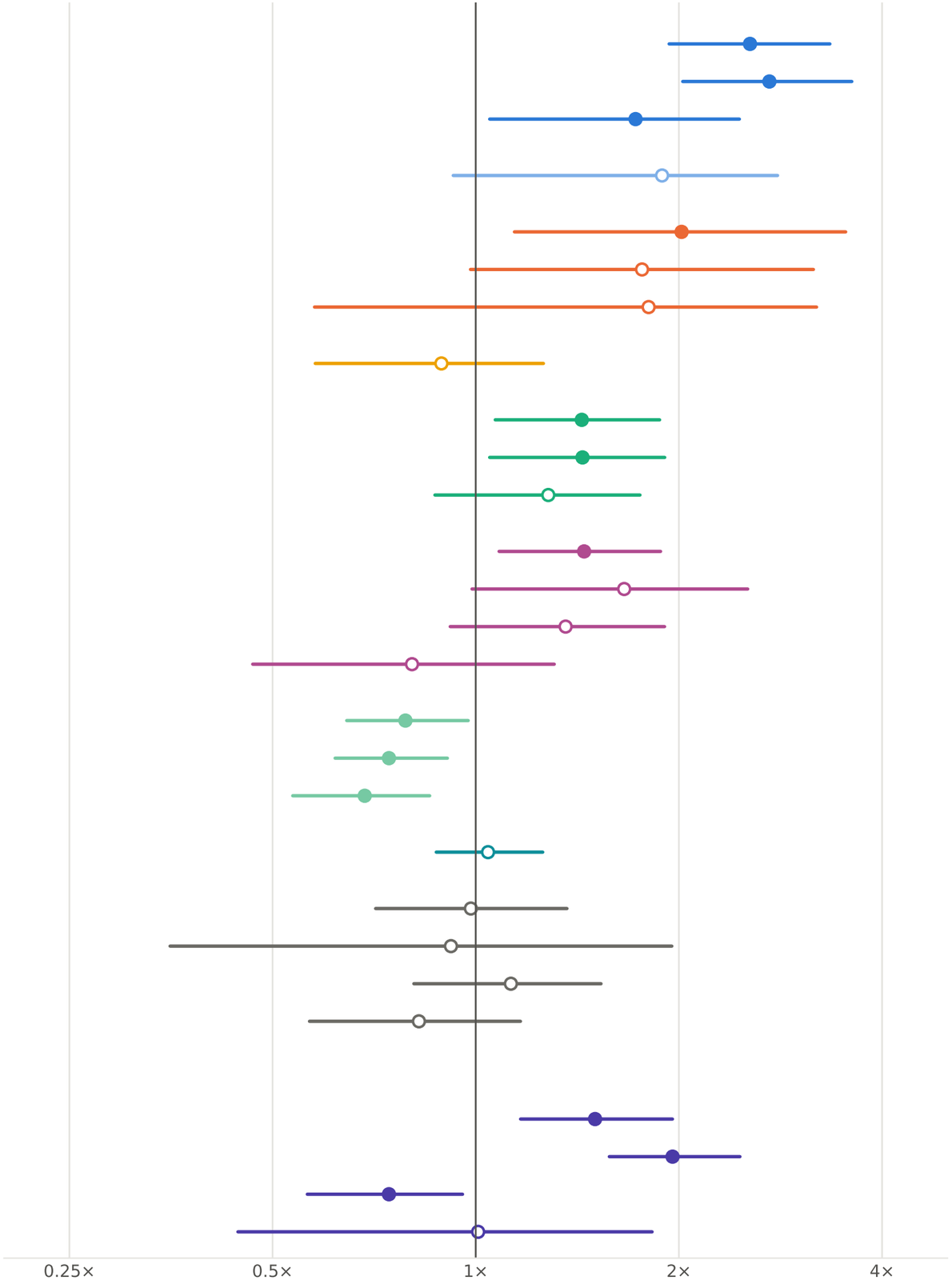Human genetics: inherited variants link the target to the disease	2.55×	n=884
Rare variants only	2.72×	n=651
Common variants only (genome-wide association studies)	1.72×	n=187
Curated pathways: a disease mutation is shown disrupting the target's pathway	1.89×	n=195
Tumour genetics: the gene is recurrently mutated in this cancer	2.02×	n=1,061
The mutation's effect matches the drug's action	1.76×	n=746
It does not, or its effect is unknown	1.80×	n=315
Diseased tissue: the gene's RNA level differs in diseased tissue	0.89×	n=907
Mouse genetics: knocked-out or mutant mice show the disease	1.44×	n=1,504
Mutant mouse phenotype closely matches the disease	1.44×	n=878
Looser match	1.28×	n=626
The drug: its binding to the target was measured before entry	1.45×	n=1,658
Binds strongly (100 nM or better) and selectively	1.66×	n=550
Binds strongly, selectivity not shown	1.36×	n=840
Binds more weakly than 100 nM	0.80×	n=268
Published animal studies of the drug before entry (exploratory)	0.79×	n=6,825
In an animal model of the disease	0.74×	n=4,655
Only in healthy animals	0.68×	n=2,170
Published study of the drug acting on its target in people (exploratory)	1.04×	n=2,183
Target safety risk	0.98×	n=4,045
Only: people rarely carry broken copies of the gene	0.92×	n=298
Only: mice without the gene die young	1.13×	n=2,416
Both	0.82×	n=1,331
For comparison: whether earlier drugs on the same target had already succeeded		
Earlier drugs on the same target	1.50×	n=4,305
Approved for a related disease	1.96×	n=2,176
Approved only for unrelated diseases	0.74×	n=2,129
No approval, but another drug failed in a related disease in the last 3 years †	1.01×	n=227